

VPA ICT Program — Grades 2–3 Course Overview

VPA ICT Program — Grades 2–3: Digital Foundations

Academic Year: 2024 – 2025 | Total Weeks: 36 | Lesson Duration: 40 minutes
Target Group: EAL learners (Mandarin L1), mixed ability | Standards: CSTA K–12, Common Core ELA/Math

Program Vision

Our Grades 2–3 ICT curriculum introduces young learners to the digital world through play-based, hands-on experiences. Students develop foundational skills in typing, digital creation, online safety, and computational thinking while building English vocabulary through bilingual scaffolding.

Curriculum Map — Three Terms

Term	Weeks	Theme	Key Skills	Standards
Term 1	1 – 12	Digital Basics	Computer parts, mouse/keyboard, typing basics	CSTA 1A-CS-01, 1A-CS-02, CCSS. ELA. SL. 2. 5
Term 2	13 – 24	Digital Creation	Digital art, word processing, storytelling	CSTA 1A-DA-06, 1A-AP-08, CCSS. ELA. W. 2. 6
Term 3	25 – 36	Safety & Algorithms	Online safety, unplugged coding, safe searching	CSTA 1A-IC-17, 1A-AP-09, CCSS. ELA. SL. 3. 2

Year at a Glance

Week	Topic	Activity Highlight
1	Welcome to the Computer Lab	Computer parts scavenger hunt
2	Mouse Skills	"Catch the Butterfly" game
3	Keyboard Introduction	Keyboard carpet mat exploration
4	Typing Letters	Alphabet typing race
5	Typing Numbers	Number pad treasure hunt
6	Typing Words	My name challenge
7	Typing Sentences	Simple sentence typing
8	Review & Games	Typing Olympics
9	Introduction to the Internet	Safe sites treasure map
10	Safe Searching	Kiddle.net exploration
11	Digital Citizenship Basics	"Good Choice / Bad Choice" sorting
12	Term 1 Assessment	Practical typing test + quiz

Week	Topic	Activity Highlight
13	Introduction to Digital Art	Tux Paint / Paint 3D exploration
14	Drawing with Shapes	Shape robot creation
15	Colors and Fill Tools	Rainbow landscape painting
16	Introduction to Word Processing	Type my favorite animal
17	Formatting Text	Make it BIG, make it small!
18	Adding Pictures to Documents	Picture + caption activity
19	Digital Storytelling	My weekend story
20	Creating a Simple Book	3-page digital book
21	Adding Speech Bubbles	Comic strip creation
22	Review & Share	Story sharing circle
23	Multimedia Creation	Voice recording + image
24	Term 2 Assessment	Digital story project
25	Online Safety Rules	"Stop, Think, Click" song
26	Personal Information	"Keep it Secret" game
27	Cyberbullying Awareness	Kind vs. Unkind words sort
28	Screen Time Balance	Healthy habits chart
29	Introduction to Algorithms	"How to Make a Sandwich" unplugged
30	Sequencing Steps	Planting a seed algorithm
31	Loops (Repeating Actions)	"Clap, Clap, Stomp" pattern loop
32	Conditional Statements	"If it's sunny, then..." game
33	Introduction to Scratch Jr	First animation project
34	Simple Animations	Moving character project
35	Review & Showcase	Project gallery walk
36	End of Year Assessment	Portfolio + practical tasks

Assessment Overview

Formative (ongoing):

Observation checklists during activities

Exit tickets with bilingual vocabulary

Peer sharing and feedback

Summative (term-end):

Practical skills demonstration

Digital portfolio (collection of work)

Teacher-guided interview assessment

Bilingual Support Strategy

Every lesson includes bilingual keywords (中文 / Pinyin) displayed on the board. Visual icons accompany all instructions. Sentence frames support EAL learners:

"I can..." / "我会... (wǒ huì...)"

"First, I... Then, I..." / "首先... 然后... (shǒuxiān... ránhòu...)"

"This is my..." / "这是我的... (zhè shì wǒ de...)"

Differentiation

Level	Support	Extension
Bronze	1:1 teacher support, visual step cards, pre-typed templates	—
Silver	Partner support, word banks, partially completed templates	Additional formatting options
Gold	Independent work with checklist	Peer teaching, creative projects, additional tools

Resources

Tux Paint / Paint 3D (digital art)

Typing.com / BBC Dance Mat Typing (typing)

Microsoft Word / Google Docs (word processing)

Scratch Jr (introductory coding)

Kiddle.net (safe search)

Classroom posters with bilingual ICT vocabulary